contact, business-to-business and government-to-government linkages for the mutual benefit of both the countries and also for the promotion of global peace and stability, economic growth and prosperity. President Obama also expressed his intention to visit India in November as he considered India to be a rising and responsible global power “indispensable” to a future American strategy.

The US President Obama’s visit to India from 6–9 November, 2010 has been a visit of a President who has just lost ground in the elections to the Senate and the House of Representatives and who wanted to show that his four-nation visit to India, Indonesia, South Korea and Japan were aimed at opening up new markets for US companies and create jobs at home. His visit ultimately proved to be full of promises of US supporting India’s membership to multilateral export control regimes like NSG, MTCR, the Australian Group (AG) and the Wassenaar Arrangement (WA) in a phased manner and removal of India’s defence and space related entities from the US ‘Entity List’. But the former cannot be done soon, for the membership criteria for these have to be amended to make India eligible and the latter, as US Fact Sheet reveals that such changes have been initiated by Obama administration from 2009 and will bring about fundamental changes in the export relationship with India. This is yet to be seen how it influences Indo-US export relationship. Another promise made by President Obama is the US support for India’s bid for a permanent seat in the UN Security Council. In his address to the Indian Parliament, Obama, however, clearly said that to earn this seat, India has to follow Washington’s line on key global issues like Iran and Myanmar with whom India has good relations. Regarding terrorism and Pakistani safe havens for terrorists, India was upset because in October 2010 the US announced $2-billion annual defence aid package to Pakistan. Again, Obama in his address stated that India and the US both have an interest in an Afghanistan and a Pakistan that is stable, prosperous and democratic. In other words, he tried to justify the aid that had been given to Pakistan just before his arrival in India. On the Kashmir issue, he said that the US was not in favour of imposing any solution but can always lend a helping hand if needed. Behind the scene, of course, another motive